ECHO WARS | FACTION 2 OF 4 | RTS BASE UNITS

Loopbound
Unit Renders & Cards

Canonical images and unit cards for all four Loopbound base units. The faction that mirrors the Awakened tier for tier - same discipline, opposite doctrine: erosion through repetition.



Above: the Echo Leech pack, canonical render. Three bodies, one pattern - the swarm form Echo locked over the original belly-leech reading.

WHAT IS IN THIS DOCUMENT

One card per unit - cost, stats, abilities, doctrine and field lore - with the canonical render beside it. The Echo Leech also gets a version page, because it is the one unit in this faction with an earlier baseline worth keeping side by side. The version marked **CANONICAL** is the current pick.

Only one cost in this faction is locked: the Echo Leech at **3 Resonance** in the RTS framing. The other three costs are provisional and will move in balance testing. Where a unit began in the parked card battler, the older battler numbers are shown in a clearly labelled origin note - they are history, not current stats.

Unit	Role	Tier	Cost	Render record
Echo Leech	Swarm / Drain	Core	3 - LOCKED	Canonical + Echo's original baseline
Cycle Priest	Recursion	Core	3 - provisional	Canonical only - designed fresh this set
Distortion Walker	Flank / Disruption	Elite	4 - provisional	Canonical only
Anchor-Line Enforcer	Control / Pressure	Elite	4 - provisional	Canonical only

With the Awakened Ones catalog, this completes **8 of the 16 base units**. Heroes stay parked until all four factions are done.

FACTION IDENTITY & VISUAL LANGUAGE

Erosion through repetition

The Loopbound were built as a mirror of the Awakened: the same tier grammar - uniform robes, one signature relic per unit, grounded core troops, epic reserved for elites - translated into the opposite voice. Where the Awakened steady the field, the Loopbound wear it down until it forgets how to resist.

> Faction law: **Erosion through repetition.**
> "They do not march forward. They return until the field forgets how to resist."
> Working thesis for the set: repeat the wound, erase the witness.

LOCKED VISUAL RULES FOR THIS SET

- **Palette:** void-purple and indigo on near-black, with violet glow accents. Bruised indigo, ghost-lilac and ash-grey; fractured armour where armour appears at all.
- **Recurring motif:** the incomplete, broken circle - a cycle that refuses to finish. It appears in the Priest's relic, in the glyph embroidery, and in the faction's broken-ring sigil.
- **Faces in shadow:** hoods carry the humanoid units; eyes, where visible, are violet points of light. Nothing in this faction shows a clear face.
- **Emaciated forms:** bodies are gaunt, stretched and slightly wrong - the Leech's hounds, the Walker's dissolving frame - rather than muscular or heroic.
- **Ground remembers:** trails, ripples and drain-glow in the ground plane are part of the faction's look, because two of its four abilities are written into the ground itself.

BATTLEFIELD CHARACTER

Trap layers, drain specialists, recursion abusers and tempo disruptors. Their places are ruined shrines, collapsed halls, repeating arches and eroded sanctums; their arms are broken-ring staves, fading script relics and orbiting distortion spheres. Every unit in this set attacks the enemy's ability to keep playing the game - resonance, cost, speed or conversion - rather than simply dealing damage.

Echo Leech



CANONICAL Three void-hounds in a misty canyon. Violet eyes and flank markings; the lead hound drains resonance straight from the ground.

3	3
RESONANCE - LOCKED	BODIES - ALWAYS

30	40	Fast
HP / BODY	DAMAGE / BODY	SPEED

DESIGN LOCK

The Leech is a **dog-like swarming unit** - emaciated hounds that run in a pack. The earlier slow, belly-crawling leech reading is retired. Echo opened this unit to further polish, but the form itself is settled.

ABILITIES

- **Resonance Drain (Passive)** - each bite siphons resonance from the target. The unit always deploys as a triple, never alone.

Further abilities are still to be designed in the RTS pass.

PERSONALITY (Q-RRG, FROM THE ORIGINAL CARD)

DIR		0.30
JIT		0.90
HES		0.40

The jitteriest unit in either faction so far - it does not run a line, it skitters as a pattern.

> The Leeches are what happens when hunger learns to run in formation. They do not hunt the body - they hunt the field itself, lapping up the resonance that holds an army together. Kill one and the pattern barely notices. Kill two and the third is already behind you.

"They are not three. They are one pattern, running."

Card origin - parked battler, not current: in the original unit cards the Leech cost 2 Resonance as a single 120 HP / 60 DMG body that drained 5 Resonance on hit and spawned in groups of three. The RTS framing above splits it into three real bodies at 30 HP / 40 DMG each under one locked cost of 3. The drain strength is a known tuning risk - the stat sheet for the battler already flagged 5 per hit as devastating and advised starting low.

Baseline and polish, side by side

Echo supplied the baseline for this unit and was open to changes. In the event, the canonical render keeps his composition almost exactly - same canyon, same three hounds, same lead hound drinking from the ground - and spends its effort on detail: sharper hide texture, stronger violet in the eyes, flank markings and drool, and a heavier mist. The two images are kept together so the polish can be judged honestly.



CANONICAL Polished render - the production asset. Detail and glow lifted; composition unchanged from the baseline.



BASELINE Echo's original upload. The starting point for the unit, and the proof the dog-like swarm form was his call from the beginning.

The other three Loopbound units have no baseline page: the Cycle Priest, Distortion Walker and Anchor-Line Enforcer were each rendered once for this set and accepted, so their card pages are their complete record.

Cycle Priest



CANONICAL Uniform dark indigo and violet robes, face lost in hood shadow, broken-circle glyphs embroidered on sleeves and hem. The Cycle Ring is held open in one hand.

3	1		
RESONANCE - PROVISIONAL	MODEL		
280	**80**	**Steady**	
HP	DAMAGE	SPEED	

SIGNATURE RELIC

Cycle Ring - a compact, open bronze mechanism, deliberately incomplete. A single fragment orbits it forever on a violet trail, repeating a circuit that never closes. It is a tool for manipulating recurrence, not a grand wizard's staff - sized to one hand, worn like an instrument.

ABILITIES

- **False Return (Death trigger)** - on death, the cycle refunds part of its cost; the next reinforcement arrives cheaper.

Battler rule, for the record: on death, the next card in hand costs 1 less Resonance. The RTS adaptation of the refund is still to be designed.

PERSONALITY (Q-RRG, FROM THE ORIGINAL CARD)

DIR		0.45
JIT		0.60
HES		0.35

> The Priests tend the wound that never closes. Each carries a broken ring - a circle that refuses to finish - and where they walk, endings come undone. They have died in corridors you have never seen, and they remember the way back.

"He has died in this corridor before. He knows where to go."

This unit had no earlier render to polish. It was designed fresh from the faction lore and the dev thread's brief - darker indigo and violet robes, a visibly incomplete or repeating circular motif, a relic that feels like a tool rather than a trophy - and it mirrors the Awakened core troops deliberately: uniform robes, one relic, grounded stance, rank in the glyphwork.

LOOPBOUND - ELITE - FLANK / DISRUPTION

Distortion Walker



CANONICAL Gaunt veiled entity caught mid-stride, two afterimages trailing behind, the body dissolving into violet static at the edges. The ground ripples where it passes.

4	1
RESONANCE - PROVISIONAL	MODEL

260	110	Fast
HP	DAMAGE	SPEED

ROLE IN THE FACTION

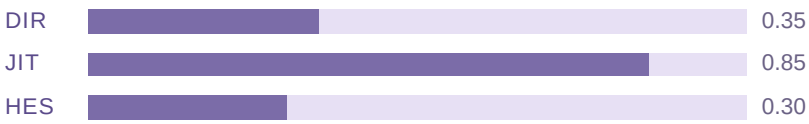
The Loopbound answer to the Veil Walker: both are fast, single-model flank elites-in-waiting that arrive where attention is not. The Walker does it by recurrence rather than by stepping through a veil - and it leaves the battlefield worse than it found it.

ABILITIES

- **Fracture Step (Passive)** - leaves a distortion trail behind it. The ground remembers its passing, and enemies crossing the trail are slowed by 25%.

Further abilities are still to be designed in the RTS pass. The trail is the signature: a flank unit that also reshapes the routes behind it.

PERSONALITY (Q-RRG, FROM THE ORIGINAL CARD)



Low directness, very high jitter - the profile of a unit that is never quite where its silhouette says it is.

> Walkers do not travel. They recur - arriving where they have already been, which is always somewhere you are not looking. The trail they leave is not damage. It is a reminder that the ground itself has started to doubt where it is.

"It does not move through space. It moves through the memory of space."

LOOPBOUND - ELITE - CONTROL / PRESSURE

Anchor-Line Enforcer



CANONICAL Hulking brute in tattered indigo robes over blackened armour. Heavy chains cross the torso and coil around both arms; two rune-etched anchor-stones hang chained at its flanks. Violet eyes in hood shadow.

4	1		
RESONANCE - PROVISIONAL	MODEL		
480	**100**	**Slow**	
HP - FACTION HIGHEST	DAMAGE	SPEED	

SIGNATURE RELIC

Anchor-Stones - rune-etched stones chained to the Enforcer's body, hanging at its flanks. Where they hang, the loop holds. They are the visual opposite of the Mirror Sentinel's single polished shield: not one perfect surface, but weight, chain and etched stone.

ABILITIES

- **Hold the Loop (Active)** - chains run out to its anchors; nearby enemies are held in the pattern and cannot break from it.

Battler rule, for the record: nearby enemies cannot be converted for 4 seconds. The RTS adaptation - how the hold works moment to moment - is still to be designed. At 480 HP this is the heaviest base unit in either completed faction, heavier than the Mirror Sentinel's 380.

PERSONALITY (Q-RRG, FROM THE ORIGINAL CARD)

DIR		0.55
JIT		0.25
HES		0.20

> The Enforcers are the Loopbound's full stop. Where they plant their anchors, the cycle holds - no escape, no change, no end. They do not chase. They arrive, they chain the ground to itself, and they wait for you to understand that running was never an option.

"Forget the way out. There is only the loop."

LOOPBOUND - ROSTER AT A GLANCE

Four units, one pattern

Read across the roster, the faction's shape is clear: a cheap swarm that taxes resonance, a priest who makes death cheaper, a flank that poisons the ground it crosses, and a heavy anchor that forbids escape. Nothing here wins by out-damaging the enemy - it wins by making the enemy's game stop working.

Unit	Tier / Role	Cost	Stats	Ability	Q-RRG (Dir / Jit / Hes)
Echo Leech	Core - Swarm / Drain	3 - LOCKED	3 bodies - 30 HP, 40 DMG each - Fast	Resonance Drain (Passive)	0.30 / 0.90 / 0.40
Cycle Priest	Core - Recursion	3 - provisional	280 HP - 80 DMG - Steady	False Return (Death trigger)	0.45 / 0.60 / 0.35
Distortion Walker	Elite - Flank / Disruption	4 - provisional	260 HP - 110 DMG - Fast	Fracture Step (Passive) - trail, 25% slow	0.35 / 0.85 / 0.30
Anchor-Line Enforcer	Elite - Control / Pressure	4 - provisional	480 HP - 100 DMG - Slow	Hold the Loop (Active)	0.55 / 0.25 / 0.20

THE MIRROR WITH THE AWAKENED

Slot	Awakened Ones	Loopbound
Core pair	Wandbearers of Echo (support squad) + Sigil Keeper (control)	Echo Leech (swarm) + Cycle Priest (recursion)
Flank	Veil Walker - steps through the Veil	Distortion Walker - recurs through the memory of space
Elite anchor	Mirror Sentinel - 380 HP, returns what is given	Anchor-Line Enforcer - 480 HP, forbids leaving
Doctrine in one line	Remind the field what it is	Return until the field forgets how to resist

Costs in this table are the current RTS framing. The Leech is the only locked cost; the Awakened Wandbearers, also at a locked 3, are its direct counterpart - two locked 3-cost cores anchoring the first two factions.

STATUS & NEXT DECISIONS

What is locked, what is still open

LOCKED

- Echo Leech cost **3 Resonance** in the RTS framing, fielded as three bodies at 30 HP / 40 DMG each.
- Echo Leech form: dog-like swarming void-hounds. The belly-leech reading is retired.
- Faction palette and motif: void-purple and indigo on near-black; the broken, incomplete circle.
- Cycle Priest relic: the open Cycle Ring with its orbiting fragment - a one-handed tool, not a staff.
- Tier grammar carried over from the Awakened: uniform robes, one signature relic, grounded cores, epic reserved for elites.
- Heroes remain parked - including the Loopbound hero render Echo already has - until all four factions' base units are done.

STILL TO CHOOSE LATER

	Decision	Current position
[ ]	Cycle Priest, Distortion Walker, Anchor-Line Enforcer costs	3 / 4 / 4, all provisional pending balance testing
[ ]	Resonance Drain strength	Battler value of 5 per hit was flagged as devastating; RTS value to be tuned, starting low
[ ]	RTS ability adaptations	False Return refund form; Hold the Loop moment-to-moment behaviour; second abilities for Leech and Walker
[ ]	Echo Leech further polish	Echo left this unit open to changes; canonical render is the current polish, not a final lock on detail

NEXT FACTION

The Architects of Collapse are next, starting from the Collapse Scribe baseline Echo already supplied - gold cloak, tome, calibration geometry - followed by the Measure Guard, the Nullcaster and the fourth base unit in that set. The same format applies: canonical render, card with cost, story and abilities, and every version kept. The Forgotten Flame closes the roster.

Source renders are held in the EchoPath unit-renders working folder. This document is the review copy - the renders themselves remain the production assets.